

Simple

The form itself is simple. All you need is your basic personal information, nothing you need to dig around for. For the last item, you need to check the boxes for Experian, TransUnion, Equifax. The whole point is to get all three at once. Check, check, check.

If you go through the internet to the Annual Credit Report site, it guides you to each of the three individual sites. It is one-stop shopping, with three separate stops. Follow the prompts, and you will get around and back again.

Easy

Go to their website (www.AnnualCreditReport.com) and select your state. Fill in the personal information. Click the boxes for Experian, Equifax, and TransUnion.

This Annual Credit Report website is linked to each of the three agencies. It takes you to every agency, one at a time, to get your free credit report from each of them. By using the annual request site, you only have to type in your main information once. AnnualCreditReport.com works as the middleman to get you what you need from all three sources. It sounds complicated and tedious, but it moves fairly quickly.

Security

When you are on the website of each credit reporting agency, you may be asked to create a free account. Enter a user name and a password. They may ask you a “secret” security question, and it is not, “What is your mother’s maiden name?” That one is too common these days. They will ask for your mother or father’s middle name or the name of your first grade teacher. These answers are not the stuff an internet hacker would readily know.

In order to proceed, the website will need to verify your identity. The TransUnion site says: “We want to ensure that you really are you.” The website will match your birth date and address records automatically, but be prepared to have account numbers handy.